

FilmIN

Product Requirements & Scenarios Spec

The open film & TV catalog of IMDb, fused with a LinkedIn-style professional network — built for the film industry.

FREE FOREVER • FUNDED BY ADS, NOT PAYWALLS

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1. Vision

FilmIN is the professional home for everyone who makes film — and the best place for fans to explore it. One trustworthy catalog of titles and credits, fused with a real professional network: owned profiles, connections, a feed, discovery, and hiring. **Free for everyone, funded by ads, never by gatekeeping people from their own work.**

2. Value Proposition — “Why FilmIN”

- **Free forever for users** — page curation, headshot/photo uploads, credits management, discovery analytics, search, and contact tools that IMDbPro charges for are all free here.
- **Owned professional identity** — you control your page, your reel, your story.
- **Real industry networking** — connect, follow, endorse, post, get discovered, find collaborators and work.
- **A catalog both sides trust** — accurate, TMDb-powered titles and credits that fans and pros use.
- **Funded by ads, not paywalls** — monetization (later) never blocks a pro from managing their page.

3. The Problem Today

- **IMDb** is resented; its moat is brand authority, not product quality. **IMDbPro** paywalls self-curation — you pay \$150/yr to upload your own headshot.
- **LinkedIn** is generic — no titles, no credits graph, no reels, no fan layer; not film-literate.
- **Letterboxd** is fans-only — no professional identity or hiring layer.
- **Fragmentation** — pros juggle IMDb + LinkedIn + a personal site + a Vimeo reel + spreadsheets. FilmIN unifies all of it, free.

4. Personas

Grouped as **Creators** (the pros), **Industry enablers** (who hire, represent, or program), **Audience** (fans & press), and **Advertisers** (future).

CREATORS — FILM PROFESSIONALS

Maya — Aspiring Actor

Goals: Visibility, polished headshots + reel, get cast.

Frustration: Paying IMDbPro just to upload a headshot.

FilmIN gives them: Claim page, curate, upload photos free; be discovered by casting.

Sam — Cinematographer / DP

Goals: Accurate credits, peer connections, signal availability.

Frustration: Credits scattered; no film-aware network.

FilmIN gives them: Verified filmography, “open to work,” worked-with network, posts.

Lia — Choreographer

Goals: Be searchable in an under-catalogued role; show a reel.

Frustration: Specialty roles poorly represented on IMDb.

FilmiN gives them: First-class support for below-the-line roles + showreel + discovery.

Dev — Writer / Screenwriter

Goals: Showcase produced + spec work; reach directors/producers.

Frustration: No good way to present a body of writing.

FilmiN gives them: Credits + projects + networking + endorsements.

Noor — Director

Goals: Showcase filmography, assemble crews, announce projects.

Frustration: Hiring + portfolio live in different places.

FilmiN gives them: Profile, people search, worked-with graph, feed.

Alex — Producer

Goals: Discover/assemble talent & crew, manage a slate, network.

Frustration: Sourcing trusted crew is slow and gated.

FilmiN gives them: People search, shortlists, worked-with graph.

Theo — Film Student / Emerging

Goals: Build a profile with no IMDb credits yet; first break.

Frustration: IMDb won't list student/indie work; invisible.

FilmiN gives them: Add your own titles + credits; build identity from scratch.

Priya — Costume Designer

Goals: Correct credit attribution; peer recognition.

Frustration: Miscredited / missing on titles.

FilmiN gives them: Claim, fix/add credits, endorsements.

INDUSTRY ENABLERS

Carmen — Casting Director

Goals: Find & shortlist talent by role/location/skills; contact them.

Frustration: IMDbPro gates search & contact behind a fee.

FilmiN gives them: Rich people search + filters + shortlists + free direct contact.

Jordan — Agent / Manager

Goals: Manage and promote a roster of clients.

Frustration: No film-native tools to promote talent.

FilmiN gives them: Manage client pages, promote, network.

Studio — Production Co. / Recruiter

Goals: Source crews, scout, post opportunities (future).

Frustration: Crewing-up relies on word of mouth.

FilmiN gives them: Search + worked-with graph + company presence (future).

Festival — Festival Programmer

Goals: Discover filmmakers; partnerships and promotion.

Frustration: Hard to find/track emerging filmmakers.

FilmiN gives them: Discovery + partnership surfaces (a marketing channel).

AUDIENCE · (FUTURE) ADVERTISERS

Joe — General Fan

Goals: "Who was in that?", release dates, fast answers.

Frustration: Cluttered, ad-heavy lookups.

FilmiN gives them: Fast, clean catalog; follow talent.

Quinn — Cinephile (Letterboxd crowd)

Goals: Track films; follow talent & critics; rate/review.

Frustration: Fan tools and pro data live apart.

FilmiN gives them: Catalog + follows + watchlists/reviews (future).

Rae — Critic / Journalist

Goals: Publish reviews/articles; build authority; get cited.

Frustration: Work gets cited to IMDb, not to them.

FilmIN gives them: Critic pages + reviews; cite FilmIN over IMDb (future).

Brandr — Advertiser / Brand (future)

Goals: Reach a film-intent audience.

Frustration: Generic ad networks lack film context.

FilmIN gives them: Ad-friendly surfaces designed without harming UX.

5. User Segments (from the brief)

Segment	Share	How FilmIN wins them
SUBSET ONE General public	~90%	Catalog lookups. Won by speed, accuracy, SEO, brand.
SUBSET TWO Working / semi-pro THE WEDGE	~9%	Want free self-curation. Easiest to win; they evangelize to peers (grassroots growth).
SUBSET THREE Established pros & companies	<1%	Previously IMDbPro payers. Pay nothing here; won by a better product + network effect.

6. Capabilities & Feature Areas

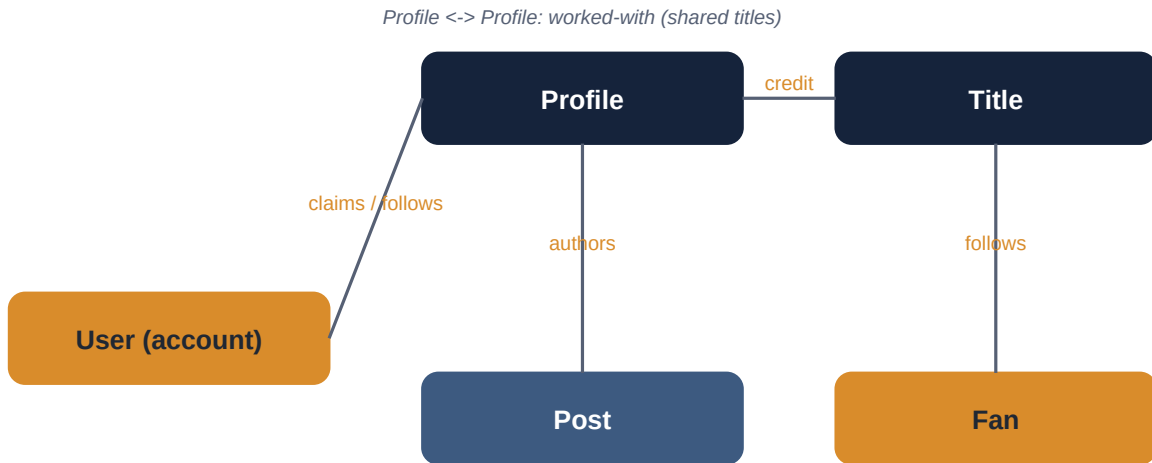
Tag [MVP] = in the first thin vertical slice; [Later] = roadmap.

- **A. Catalog & Discovery** — [MVP] title pages (poster, year, synopsis), cast/crew, title search, trending rows, and a **Discover** browse page (role chips, trending, new releases, people to follow).
- **B. Professional Identity** — [MVP] claim a page, profile (bio, roles, location, links), free headshot/photo upload; [Later] skills/tags, reel gallery.
- **C. Credits & Filmography** — [MVP] profile–title credits; [Later] add missing titles/credits (student/indie), correction requests.
- **D. Professional Network** — [MVP] follow, worked-with (derived from shared titles), and “**people you may know**” suggestions; [Later] mutual connections, endorsements, “open to work.”
- **E. Feed & Posts** — [MVP] a **personalized network feed on Home** (posts + worked-with activity from your network, ranked by recency and proximity, with an **extended-network** tier), posts/updates, likes; [Later] comments.
- **F. Hiring & Discovery** — [Later] people search by role/location/skills, shortlists, direct contact (all free).
- **G. Fan Engagement** — [MVP] follow talent; [Later] watchlists, ratings/reviews.
- **H. Critic & Editorial** — [Later] critic pages, reviews/articles.
- **I. Notifications** — [Later].
- **J. Trust & Safety** — [Later] verification badges (claimed/verified pro), reporting/moderation.
- **K. Ads & Monetization** — [Later] (ad-friendly layout considered now).

7. The FilmIN Graph (Relationships)

The product is a graph connecting people, their work, and the audience:

- **Person** —[Credit: role/character/job]— **Title** — the spine of the catalog.
- **Person** —[Worked-with]— **Person** — derived automatically from shared titles.
- **User** —[Owns/Claims]— **Profile** — a profile is an *unclaimed stub* until a user claims it.
- **User** —[Follows]—> **Profile**; (future) **Person** <-> **Person** mutual connection + endorsement.
- **Person** —[Authors]— **Post** —[Reaction]— **User**.
- **Fan** —[Follows]—> **Talent**; (future) **Fan** —[Watchlist/Rating]— **Title**.



8. Scenarios (End-to-End Use Cases)

Each scenario: persona · trigger · steps · outcome. [MVP] = supported by the first thin slice.

S1 [MVP] — The free headshot (Maya).

Signs up, searches her imported page, clicks “This is me” to claim it, edits bio/roles, and uploads headshots for free. *Value: the headline IMDbPro-killer.*

S2 [Later] — Casting a choreographer (Carmen → Lia).

Searches “Choreographer, LA, musical theatre,” shortlists Lia, views her reel, and contacts her — all free. *Value: hiring without paywalls.*

S3 [Later] — Building from zero (Theo).

With no IMDb credits, creates a profile, adds his student films as titles + credits, and connects with classmates. *Value: emerging talent gets an identity IMDb won’t give.*

S4 [MVP] — Open to work (Sam → Noor).

Sam marks “open to work” and posts a wrap announcement; Noor (in Sam’s network) sees it on her **Home** feed and connects. Posts from friends-of-friends surface in an **extended-network** tier, and “**people you may know**” suggests collaborators. *Value: the network creates work.*

S5 [MVP] — Fan lookup (Joe).

Searches a film; the title page shows cast/crew linked to profiles; he follows an actor. *Value: fast, credible catalog; fan→talent follow graph.*

S6 [Later] — Fixing a credit (Priya).

Finds a missing/mis-attributed credit on a title and requests a correction; the credit is fixed. *Value: accuracy owned by the people who did the work.*

S7 [Later] — Assembling a crew (Alex).

Uses people search and the worked-with graph to assemble a trusted crew.

S8 [Later] — Critic citations (Rae).

Publishes reviews on a critic page; outlets cite FilmIN over IMDb.

S9 [MVP] — Following talent + worked-with (Quinn).

Browses people on **Discover**, follows talent, and explores who they’ve worked with via shared titles.

9. Differentiators (vs the Field)

Capability	IMDb	IMDbPro	LinkedIn	Letterboxd	FilmIN
Open film/TV catalog	Yes	Yes	No	Fan	Yes
Self-curate page / upload headshots	No	Paid	Generic	No	Yes (free)
Film-aware credits graph	View	Yes	No	No	Yes

Professional networking & hiring	No	Partial/paid	Generic	No	Yes (free)
Fan engagement layer	Yes	No	No	Yes	Yes
Cost to professionals	Free (view)	\$150/yr	Free/paid	Free	\$0

10. Principles (Non-Functional)

- Free core forever; the user owns their data and identity.
- Catalog accuracy; accessibility; fast and mobile-friendly.
- SEO for fan traffic (SUBSET ONE growth).
- Privacy-respecting; legal (TMDB attribution; no IMDb data or scraping).
- Ad-friendly, but never UX-hostile.

11. Success Metrics

- Claimed profiles; headshots uploaded; % of credits on claimed pages.
- Connections/follows created; weekly active users (pros vs fans).
- Catalog coverage; casting/people searches (future); grassroots referral signups.

12. Monetization (Future, Post-Traction)

Ads · sponsored discovery placements · festival/casting partnerships · product placement. **Hard rule: never paywall a professional's own page or core networking.** Outcome per the brief: scale ad revenue, or acquisition.

13. Glossary

- **Title** — a film or TV work.
- **Credit** — a person's role on a title.
- **Profile** — a person's page; an *unclaimed stub* until *claimed* by its owner.
- **Claim** — proving/asserting a page is yours.
- **Follow** (one-way) vs **Connection** (mutual, future).
- **Worked-with** — a link between people derived from shared titles.
- **Reel** — a showcase video. **Endorsement** — a peer vouch (future).

This product uses the TMDB API but is not endorsed or certified by TMDB. No IMDb data is used or scraped.